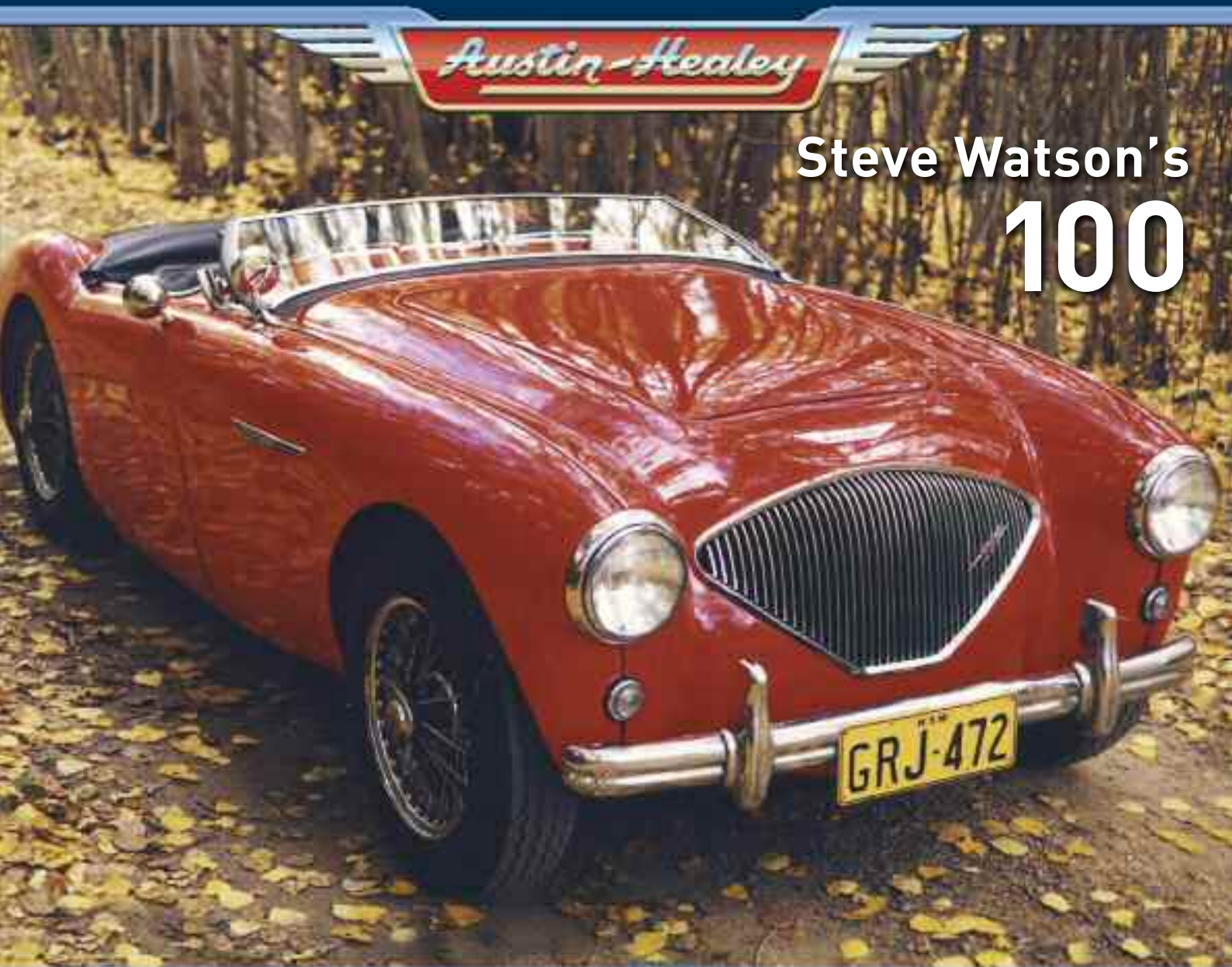


Flat Chat

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC



Steve Watson's
100

JULY 2011

**NEW MEMBERS - VINCE AND NATALIE CESSARIO
TOUCHING UP THAT ROUGH PATCH
LITTLE WORKS AUSTIN-HEALEYS
CERAMIC COATING OF MANIFOLDS
MOMENT IN TIME - LANCE'S 100**

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Flat Chat is the official publication of the Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc., and is published monthly by Vintage Racecar Journal Pty Ltd.

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Contributions for the magazine can also be emailed to the editor at:
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Flat Chat Editor
Patrick Quinn



ON THE COVER

Starting on page 10 you can read about not just one of Steve Watson's 100s, but four.

Flat Chat

JULY 2011

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY CLUB (NSW) INC

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DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

2011

JULY

- 13 • Monthly Meeting
- 17 • Picnic at Cataract Dam
- 20 • Committee Meeting
- 26 • Midweek run to Megalong Valley

AUGUST

- 10 • Monthly Meeting
- 17 • Committee Meeting
- 20-21 • Shannons Classic Eastern Creek
- 28 • All British Display Day

SEPTEMBER

- 8-11 • Speed on Tweed
- 14 • Monthly Meeting
- 21 • Committee Meeting
- 23-25 • HSRCA Wakefield Park

OCTOBER

- 12 • General Meeting
- 19 • Committee Meeting
- 22-29 • Charlie's "Underbelly" Run

NOVEMBER

- 9 • General Meeting
- 12 • Garden Open Day Run
- 16 • Committee Meeting

If you have any questions about the above events please contact our acting club secretary Alan Mitchell on (02) 9639 9450.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

JOHN KENT

Goulburn weather being what it is, Wakefield Park in winter is always a risk. Heavy fog meant that no track action could take place for some time. However, after it lifted about 10.30am it turned out to be a beautiful still and clear blue-sky day. These are the risks with Wakefield Park at this time of the year. This year a number of stalwarts were away at Eastern Creek so a new crew of scrutineers had to take over and did an excellent job.

Under the circumstances a field of 105 was a very good outcome. Six of those were Austin-Healeys. We also had a larger than usual number of lady helpers, on flag points, in the office and lap counting. Drivers had the opportunity of four sessions on the circuit if their car was in running order.

The dinner on the Saturday night was also a great time for fellowship and good banter. I would like to thank all members who turned up to help on the day, six of whom were novices at Wakefield Park. The day was also financially successful, which is important given the time involved by all in making it happen.



VICE PRESIDENT'S REPORT

TERRY BANCROFT

By the time you receive this issue of Flat Chat, Patricia and I would have attended both the 2011 Austin-Healey Rendezvous and Conclave in the United States.

When these events have been finalised, further information will be available on the 2012 Rendezvous and the 2012 International Conclave in Louisville, Kentucky.

So you wish to check www.healeyclub.org for the International Conclave of 2012 and also have a look at www.cascadeahc.homestead.com. These sites will provide you the particulars on both Rendezvous and Conclave you may have been looking for to help you with organising a trip to the US and Canada next year.

After we return with Patrick's help I hope to be boring you all in the August Flat Chat about our trip and the terrific people we met. Maybe if you're nice I'll throw in a few piccies.



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Stuart McCall

CMC Delegates
Ray Roberts

Assoc of British Car Clubs Rep
Sue Darlington

Please do not call committee members after 9pm.

Flat Chat is published on behalf of the Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW (Inc) by Vintage Racecar Journal Pty Ltd., 116 Warks Hill Rd., Kurrajong Heights NSW 2758

The opinions expressed in Flat Chat are not necessarily those of the Editor or the AHOC (NSW) (Inc).

MID-WEEK CLUB RUN TO MEGALONG VALLEY TEAROOMS

for lunch on Tuesday 26th July

Meet at McDonalds M4 Motorway, Eastern Creek
at 10:45am for an 11:00am departure



Take a look at their website
www.megalongtearooms.com

For further info contact Allan Whitehouse
Mob: 0418 477 862
Email: allanwhitehouse@inet.net.au

Situated at the peak of the spectacular Blue Mountains, nestled beneath stunning sandstone cliffs and mountain rainforest, Megalong Valley Tearooms is renowned for its 'Devonshire Teas', home-made apple pies, delicious home-style cooking and friendly country hospitality. Enjoy a superb home-cooked meal in the warmth of the dining room beside a cosy log fire on a cold winter's day.

From the Great Western Highway, turn at the traffic lights at Blackheath, cross the railway line and follow the signs to Megalong Valley. Megalong Valley Tearooms is situated less than 10km from the Highway. Enjoy the beautiful scenic drive through the rainforest to the valley floor.



Greeting and welcome to the July issue of *Flat Chat* and it's been just one day since, with the kind assistance of Eric Rudd we managed to lift the engine of the Quinn Austin-Healey. So who says that six out of a four doesn't go? I thought it was tricky squeezing a six-cylinder engine through a 100 bonnet opening, but Eric didn't bat an eyelid. More of that next month.

I can't say that I have been bowled over in the rush with members sending me photos of what they have been doing on their cars, and I certainly don't imagine for a second that our cars are not being fettled. So come on, the next time you put a spanner to your car make sure you have your camera handy.

So what's in this month's Flat Chat? Well the cover story is on Steve Watson and his 100, his 100, his 100 and his 100. Steve has been besotted with Austin-Healeys since 1970 and yes he has gathered together four 100s since then. For those of us who have purchased their cars relative recently you will somewhat surprised at the vast sums Steve outlaid for his cars. One of Steve's cars is historically significant having been raced by Bob Cutler during the late 1950s and early '60s.

What I said above is not quite correct, as Allan Whitehouse has been very kind by sending in some words and pics of what happens when someone comes around to touch up your car. Thanks Allan. Welcome also to new members Vince and Natalie Cessario along with their freshly imported BJ8.

Fancy a Works Austin-Healey at your place? Well you can, but you may have to squint a little so that it looks to be as big as the real thing. Starting on page 16 is all you wanted to know about the new 1:18 scale Works cars from Kyosho.

Interested in reducing radiated heat under the bonnet of your Austin-Healey? Want to improve the appearance of the exhaust manifolds? You can do this by having the manifolds ceramic coated. I have just had it done and it looks wonderful. The details start on page 18.

This month's Moment in Time is a little different as it revolves around a meeting with an ex owner at Wings Over Illawarra. His name is Lance Harkus and is interested in knowing if the 100 he owned during the late '50s and early '60s still exists. Lance later communicated by email and forwarded a photo of his car. Perhaps it's now the car you own?

In closing I pass on the sad news of the death of Ray Jorgensen. Longer term members will recall Ray as the proprietor of a motor vehicle body repair business in Pittsworth, Queensland as well as being a 100S owner. He would later go on to restore the 100S of our own Alan Jones and was restoring Austin-Healeys for owners in the years before the initial influx of cars from overseas during the 1980s. Well known Queensland Austin-Healey historian Joe Jarick has kindly sent us a vale for inclusion in next month's *Flat Chat*. Our condolences are extended to Beris and family.



CSCA CHAMPIONSHIP

AHOC Combined Sports Car Association Supersprint Wakefield Park – 25 June 2011



Saturday the 25th of June saw our turn to host a round of the CSCA Championship.

Not an easy task as it takes a sizable workforce to make sure everything goes

according to plan. Scrutineers, marshals, starters, timers, and all sorts of odds and bods were needed, and thanks to the concerted effort from club members the day went smoothly, even if it all started in fog. Special thanks should also be given to John and Carolyn Kent for their organising of the event.

The supersprint attracted 105 entrants including five Austin-Healeys and another vehicle driven by a club member.

The fastest time of the day went to Stephen Anslow in a Mazda RX7 with 1min 03.9484secs which is an average speed of 124kph.

Our members achieved the following:

Cameron Sell	Austin-Healey 3000	1min 8.7363secs
Scott Graham	Austin-Healey 3000	1min 23.3661secs
Michael Branson	Austin-Healey 3000	1min 28.8241secs
Greg Denning	Austin-Healey 3000	1min 28.8380secs
Chris Komor	Austin-Healey 100	1min 30.0956secs
Patrick Townshend	Valiant Charger	1min 11.1446secs

■ MONTHLY MEETING DATE: 8TH JUNE 2011

MEETING COMMENCED: 8:01 PM

Apologies: Doug and Pamela Ross; Don and Margo Hardie; Stephen Clark; Chris Dimmock

New Members/Visitors: Jonathan Quinn

■ PRESIDENT

- National Rally 2013 currently looking at location options.
- AHOC Supersprint at Wakefield Park is on 26-27 June 2011 and All British Race Day Sunday 26/6/2011
- Anne Read is looking after bookings for accommodation and Saturday night dinner – please if you are attending and have not made accommodation booking contact Anne Read.

■ VICE PRESIDENT

- Brass Monkey Run – 127 Adults & 1 child attended net profit \$916.20
- Rendezvous 2012 (US West Coast Meeting) is being held early July 2012 on Vancouver Island, BC Canada. Any one interested in attending please contact Terry Bancroft for more information.
- US Conclave 2012 in Kentucky is occurring 17 to 22 June and could be a good opportunity to be able to attend both events. If interested please contact Terry Bancroft.

■ SECRETARY

Mail received:

- Allure Garage Tile collection of garage flooring options that is oil resistant, does not discolour from rubber tyres or the heat from tyres (any interest please contact Garry Hayres, Harvey Norman Silverwater ph 1300 737 768 mob 0412 766 853 email garry.hayres@au.harveynorman.com Garry is offering 5% rebate to the club from any member who purchases the product.
- Forrester's Beach Resort Central Coast Highway Forrester's Beach accommodation and facilities options available for Clubs and Club Events.
- V8 Supercars Championship. Sydney Telstra 500 Sydney at Olympic Park 2-4 December 2011 looking for Club participation in Armor All Auto Show as display of fine Classic vehicles as well as parade lap on the Saturday and Sunday. Please contact the Secretary for more details or call Ian or Sandy of Raceline events on racelinepromo@yahoo.com ph (07) 5537 8255
- Certificate II in Engineering in Motor Racing at Granville TAFE. 18 week course commencing 18 July at the cost of \$325.00. Contact the TAFE at Granville on (02) 9760 6565 or mob 0411 470 712
- Allstar Graphics custom printing of T-Shirts and other clothing

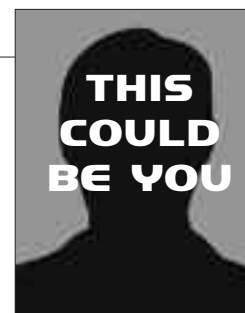
Events and Activities:

- Kiama Vintage & Classic Rally for Charity Sunday 25 September 2011 registration of motor car \$50.00 (entry fee \$10.00 & donation to charity \$40.00) full details are available www.kiama-car-rally.blogspot.com or register www.kiamacarally.info
- Liverpool Super Swap Meet Sunday 17 July 2011 admission \$3.00 per person swappers per site \$30.00 more information can be obtained from swap@chryslerclub.org.au or visit the www.chryslerclub.org.au website
- Yass Antique Motor club Celebration of Heritage Motoring Saturday 5 November 2011 Banjo Paterson Park Yass further details available from Ken Reidy Club President 02 6226 1944 or www.yamc.com.au

Magazines received:

- Yass Antique Motor Club Inc June/July 2011

- Healeys West (AHOC WA) May 2011
- Hundreds & Thousands (AHOC VIC) June 2011
- Sidescreen TR Register of Australia June/July 2011
- Highlands Steam and Vintage Fair Newsletter May 2011



■ TREASURER • Bank balances at: \$19,538 – \$12,016 – cash management account.

\$62,000 – term deposit. Any accounts can you please get them to the Treasurer prior to 30/6/2011 so we can get them in this year's accounts.

■ SOCIAL SECRETARY Events:

Saturday/Sunday 25/26 June – AHOC Supersprint Wakefield Park
Sunday 17 July – Picnic at Cataract Dam – meeting point details to come.
Tuesday 26 July – midweek run to Megalong Valley Tea Rooms – Allan Whitehouse organising (any info please contact either Social Secretary or Allan whitehouse)
Sunday 21 August – Shannons Eastern Creek Classic
Sunday 28 August – All British Display Day Kings School North Parramatta

■ EDITOR • Magazine due out in a couple of days – currently with printer

- If you are doing work on your car please take some photos and send to Patrick Quinn – he will be in contact and will write an article about the work and include in the magazine.

■ COMPETITION SECRETARY • Peter Jackson did 1:51 at Eastern Creek recently – great effort Peter

■ HISTORIAN • Nil report

■ REGALIA/PUBLIC RELATIONS • New “T” shirts from US – Austin-Healey Logo \$25.00 each (US sizes)

- Awaiting more details on the Austin-Healey mirrors – stay tuned.

■ PUBLIC RELATIONS • Nil report

■ LIBRARIAN • Nil report

■ CLUB REGO • Nil report

■ MEMBERSHIP • 34 members attending the meeting tonight and two Austin-Healeys.

■ CMC • CMC Heritage Day – very successful 50 cars at Bella Vista Park; 300 cars at Chevalier College Bowral.

- Upgrade to Eastern Creek with a \$50M injection of funds to cover motor museum, meeting rooms

■ GENERAL BUSINESS • National Rally

- Book Barn at Windsor has 2 Austin-Healey books
 - 1/43 scale Austin-Healey models on eBay
- tomotive course and have been placed into NRMA Mrve and patrol.

■ FOR SALE/WANTED • Nil

■ MEETING CONCLUDED • Meeting concluded at 9.05 pm.

MEMBERSHIP REPORT • CHRISTINE LYTTLE

I am pleased to report that the Club's membership has grown a little to 280.

This has come about through the rejoining of two past members - Bruce Reynolds and Scott Graham. It's good to see them back in the Club.

New members this month are Peter and Margaret Barnes from Mudgee with the ex Rod Richards 3000 BJ8 MK111. Both Peter

and Margaret recently attended the Brass Monkey Run that finished in their hometown. Welcome to both of you and hope to see you at another event soon. Also don't forget to check the website for regular updates - thanks to our acting Secretary Alan Mitchell. The address is www.austinhealeynsw.com.au and a membership form can be downloaded.

Look forward to seeing all the members at an event soon.

SOCIAL SCENE • CHRISTINE LYTTLE

FUTURE EVENTS

JULY - Wednesday 13th - General Meeting - Rydalmere Bowling Club. **Sunday 17th** - Picnic at Cataract Dam - Gates of the dam surroundings do not open until 10am, but to ensure we get a lovely picnic spot we should be there at that time to secure our spot. Meet at Campbelltown at 9am on the Narellan Road on the left hand side after we exit the Hume Highway before the traffic lights to the university. We will then head to Appin Road on the southern outskirts of Campbelltown. At Appin take the left turn towards Wollongong and the dam is on the right about 6 kilometres on and then about 4 kilometres into the dam. This is a good location for the Wollongong and Southern Highland members so hope you can also be there. Bring along a picnic or the makings for a BBQ as facilities are available. Plus don't forget chairs, blankets and whatever else you need. To date I have not had a good response for this event **so please ring me if you intend to go** otherwise we may cancel especially if the day is not fine and very cold. **Tuesday 26th** - Mid Week Run to Megalong Valley - meet at McDonalds Restaurant M4 Motorway Eastern Creek 10.45am for 11.00am departure. Approximate time of arrival at Megalong Valley is noon. If you prefer to go directly to the Tearooms cross the railway at 5 Blackheath and follow signs to Megalong Valley (approx 10 kms). Contact Allan Whitehouse on 0418 477 962 or email allanwhitehouse@iinet.net.au if you wish to advise your attendance or if you need to contact Allan on the day.

AUGUST - Wednesday 10th - General Meeting - Rydalmere Bowling Club. **Sat/Sun 20th - 21st** - Shannons Classic Eastern Creek - Tickets available from Alan Mitchell. **Sunday 28th** - All British Display Day - Kings School - Tickets available from Alan Mitchell.

SEPTEMBER - Thurs/Sun 8th - 11th - Speed on Tweed - There is some confusion as to whether this event is being held in 2011. In 2010 it was joined with the Repco Rally which this year is being held at Coffs Harbour. There is one website stating that it's being held at Murwillumbah 5th - 6th September which is a Monday and Tuesday. It is suggested that you check before you make your plans. **Wednesday 14th** - General Meeting - Rydalmere Bowling Club

OCTOBER - Wednesday 12th - General Meeting - Rydalmere Bowling Club. **Sat/Sat 22nd - 29th** - Charlie's Run - the bookings are filling up - contact Neil Thew if you wish to attend - please see the report in May 2011 Flat Chat.

NOVEMBER - Wednesday 9th - General Meeting - Rydalmere Bowling Club. **Saturday 12th or Sunday 13th** - Garden Open Day at Quinn's - Date to be Confirmed.

If you would like to host/organise an event please do not hesitate to contact me with your ideas. Please put these dates in your diary/calendar - the Club needs your support in 2011. Would be great to see lots of members and their Austin-Healeys on the road this year.



EXPRESSIONS OF INTEREST

To assist us with our forward planning, the Austin Healey Owners Club of Qld Inc would appreciate your expression of interest in attending the 2012 National Rally to be held at the Novotel Twin Waters Resort, Sunshine Coast Qld between Friday 6 April, 2012 and Monday 9 April, 2012.

To register your interest could you please advise Chris Miles by email to chris.miles@ctcplc.com of your name, number of people, email address, telephone number and club by 31 July 2011.

Thank you very much for your interest. We look forward to welcoming you to a great rally and a wonderful holiday in a beautiful part of Queensland.

The Organising Committee for the 2012 National Rally
www.austinhealeyclub.com.au





Profile: Vince and Natalie Cessario

Name: Vince Cessario

Occupation: Motor Vehicle Body Repairer

Where Do You Live? Ryde, NSW

What Model Austin-Healey? 3000 BJ8 Phase 2

Why did you buy an Austin-Healey? I have always liked them. We also have a MK1 Sprite and last year we went to the All British Day and just loved the Big Healeys and decided there and then that I would get one. I also have some great memories of years ago when I used to repair them.

Did you specifically set out to buy the model that you bought? I wanted a BJ8 and started looking through various magazines and on the Internet. Then I spoke to Terry Bancroft when he was president of the club. Terry was extremely helpful and gave me a few contacts and I got in touch with them all during my search.

I was looking through Just Cars and saw one for sale by what appeared to be a dealer in California, that seemed to be exactly what I was looking for. So I annoyed the seller a few times on the phone over a period of two to three weeks. Then he was away for a week, but I eventually was offered first option. The deal was clinched just before Christmas last year and I then made arrangements for it to be shipped to Australia. Actually it came in through South Australia, which did cost be a few extra dollars, but it seemed to be the best way at the time. It finally arrived on my door on 1st April after what seemed to be a very long time.



What was it like when you bought it?

I did see quite a few photos of the car beforehand so I knew what I was in for. I probably paid a little too much for the car, but by then I really wanted it.

From a distance it didn't look so bad from the outside. There were a few dents here and there plus there was rust in all the usual places like the floors and sills. It was white when I bought it, but going on the Heritage Certificate it was black when new. So it's going to be black again with red trim.

How have you been using the car? I haven't been using the car at all. Right now it's been completely stripped down and work is about to start on the chassis. I have bought a rotisserie that has yet to arrive and after that the chassis will go off to be sand blasted prior to any repairs that will need doing.

That's when the major work will start, but at the moment I have been doing a few smaller things and buying a few bits and pieces. Right now I have been rebuilding the heater box and the spares have been coming from AH Spares in England.

I am really looking forward to getting stuck into doing what's necessary. After all I should be okay with the structural and body repairs given the type of business I am in.

I'm pretty keen on concours, but do think there should be two distinct types of judging. You can either drive a car or trailer it. I am very particular with the body, and as I also want to drive it everything has to work properly. I intend to restore so it's relatively standard and as original as I can. ■

Fancy a Bit of a "Touch Up"?

You know those annoying minor body dents and scratches or gutter-scuffed wheel rims on your "pride-and-joy" which you've been meaning to attend to for ages? You haven't gotten to it because: a) the car will be off the road for several days, b) your local repair shop is run by a bunch of shonks, c) your wife has expensive tastes in shoes, or d) it's all just too hard? Well, procrastinate no longer, help is at hand and you won't need to sell your firstborn child to pay for it!

For ages I had lived with numerous stone chips on the BJ7, but it was the need for repairs to my everyday car which finally stirred me into action. I had two issues: deep scratches and a crack in the corner of the plastic rear bumper bar – the result of an unprovoked attack by a wire fence – and ugly scrapes around the circumference of a couple of alloy wheels, following an intimate encounter with a concrete kerb.

After a little research on the Internet and seeing an advert in the back pages of "Top Gear" magazine, I shortlisted two companies which I thought could undertake this work.

The first was "Touchup Guys" (www.touchupguys.com.au) who specialise in repairing chips, scratches and bumper damage. I called their local rep, Steve Devrell (0421 706 616), and discussed what I wanted done. Any initial concerns I might have had about his expertise or workmanship were soon allayed, and indeed I could not be happier with the final result. The repairs to the



bumper are excellent, the cost was less than half the amount quoted by my local body shop, and the work was completed in my garage in around 3 hours. While waiting for the paint to dry Steve spent half an hour or so attending to the stone chips and other blemishes in the Austin-Healey paintwork.

Next came the wheel repairs, where I arranged for John (1300 933 299) from "The Wheelman" (www.mobilealloywheelrepairs.com.au) to machine, repaint and clear coat the two scuffed wheels. Conveniently this work was also carried out in-situ, with the wheels remaining on the car. The only downside however is that they do not repair chrome wheels as there is no-one in Sydney who will re-chrome them.

I was extremely pleased to have these niggling repairs carried out to both my road car and the BJ7 at a reasonable cost. The people were experienced and competent, and came to my place at a time and day which suited me. I can highly recommend their services.



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Proprietor: John Dowsett AMIAME

Steve Watson's 100

Bob Cutler and Ian 'Pete' Geoghegan (right) at Gnoo Blas. Steve Watson Collection.



Just after the start of the first race at Warwick Farm. Bob Cutler Collection.

Just what happened to them all? Over a thousand Austin-Healey 100s were imported new into Australia and there are probably less than 600 still here, including those more recently imported.

Racing photos from the 1950s are highly evocative, but it does make you think occasionally 'Where are they now?' I suspect sadly, that many have ended up as scrap, especially during the late 1950s and 1960s when the Austin-Healey 100 was nothing more than yesterday's car. After all if you wanted one, there were always the six-cylinder models to spend your money on.

To many, part of Austin-Healey ownership is knowing the history of your car as after all, your 100 may have been on the grid at Mount Druitt or Phillip Island.

So it was a pleasure to have a word with long term member Steve Watson about his Austin-Healeys. Yes it's in the plural as

there are four 100s in the Watson household, but he thinks he probably paid too much money for every one of them. One of Steve's 100s is probably the most successful Austin-Healeys that competed in Australia.

University

Steve bought his first 100 in 1970 before his initial year at University. It was painted yellow with a black hardtop.

"Yes it was yellow." Steve said. "No not like Primrose Yellow, but more like Yellow Cab yellow that sort of yelled at me. Then there was the black hardtop that I had to get rid of very quickly as I couldn't see the point of a sports car with a fold down screen and having it under a hardtop. I still think that and where Donald had penned "fold up windscreen for dire weather conditions" Len Lord scribbled "fold down"."



Racing in torrential rain during the first race at Warwick Farm. Bob Cutler Collection.



So much rain fell on the Warwick Farm circuit that it was almost impossible to see your way. Bob Cutler Collection.

The Cutler Car

There has been a number of Austin-Healeys that have featured significantly in the history of Australian motor sport. In our Club many of us immediately think of Ross Bond and his 3000. However that was in the late 1960s and early 1970s. There were examples before that and mostly four-cylinder cars. Of course the five 100S models imported new to Australia feature very significantly in our history.

Earlier on I mentioned how evocative are the racing photos of the 1950s and within so many of them you will see Austin-Healey 100s being used with some enthusiasm. Last year we featured an interview with Frank Matich about his 100 and despite being their family car; it provided him with his early knowledge that would eventuate in him building racing cars under his own name.

The story goes that Frank was running his 100 in a hillclimb on the South Coast when he was somewhat surprised by the speed of another 100 being driven by a Camden driver by the name of Bob Cutler. This car would go on to be one of the most highly developed 100s in Australia and with 40 plus wins or FTDs out of 62 starts, one of the most successful.

In the earlier days of our Club while many members knew of the car's history and were looking for it, its whereabouts was unknown. It was a matter of Steve Watson being in the right place at the right time.

Follow Leads

"I had heard about the Cutler car many times." Steve said. "Every time I would hear a story or get a lead I would chase it up, but without success. Then in late 1972 the car turned up at an event, but before anyone had a chance to chase down the driver it was gone. Then during the following year I was at a club event at Concord in the blue 100 and I was approached by an older gentleman who said that his son had a 100S. Then he said that it wasn't really a 100S, but it was a lot quicker and had been raced by someone by the name of Bob Cutler."

"He then asked me if I would like to have a look at the car and of course I said that I would. Arrangements were made for me to

"The car was great, but not so the colour and something had to be done so over Easter 1971 I painted it Ice Blue. I bought it from fellow club member Tim Bradley and with almost 12 months rego it cost me \$650 which I thought was excessive. I drove it home and still have it. That car has never let me down except that it sat in the garage for some years while I worked on my veterinary practice."

Green 100

"Then in 1972 I bought a green 100." Steve added. "Back then we would all scoured Saturday's Sydney Morning Herald for Austin-Healeys for sale. However if you were clever you would be waiting in Broadway just after midnight for the moment the paper was released. After looking through the cars for sale you would do the decent thing and wait to about 4am to phone the owner to negotiate on the car while he was still half asleep."

"So we sort of settled on a price and I arrived at his place a little early. The car sounded exactly what I was looking for, a parts car. It was very straight in the body with just 70,000 miles on the clock. Anyway the car was at Dural and I lived at Oatley at the time. It was probably \$20 or \$25 more than it was worth, but we had agreed on \$325 and then I asked how I was going to get it home. We agreed that I would pay him some of the money then and he would deliver it to my place and I would pay him the rest. That's exactly what happened and I then took him to the train station and it was the last I saw of him. Apart from a few things I did take off it to fit to my first 100 that car is how I bought it. In a way it was an original barn find and it's still sitting in a barn waiting for its day in the sun. It is the only one of the Austin-Healeys that is not fully registered."



Warwick Farm and Ian 'Pete' Geoghegan leading in his Daimler SP250 followed by Bob Cutler's 100. Bob Cutler Collection.



Bob Cutler hard cornering in his 100 at Warwick Farm. Bob Cutler Collection.

have a look the following Sunday at Cammeray and needless to say I kept quiet about it."

"I arrived at 9am as arranged." Steve added. "Looking at the car was a real experience as the owner had the car for a few years, using it quite a bit including a trip to Cairns and back. It was Sunday morning, the car was unregistered, there was no windscreen fitted and before long we were doing 70 – 80 mph down the main street of Cammeray with the engine turning over at 6,000rpm though 1st and 2nd gear. Thankfully it stopped as well as it went."

Noting Like It

"I had never been in anything like it." Steve commented. "So I asked the guy what he was going to do with the car and all he said was that if I wanted, I could go for another ride at a later time. In the end I asked for first refusal and to my surprise he agreed. It was a very meek and mild drive home in comparison."

"A few weeks later he called me and asked if I was serious about buying the car. He had a young family, mortgage and that sort of thing and really needed an everyday car in the shape of a Fiat 125. He didn't know what he wanted for the car and I didn't know what it was worth. Eventually I remembered that the most expensive Austin-Healey that John Thompson's Sports Cars had at the time was going for \$1,650 so I offered him that. He agreed, but I then said that if he wanted to back away from

the deal I would agree. While \$1,650 doesn't sound like much today, it was a fair offer considering that a 100S came up for sale not long after for \$3,600."

"It was still unregistered and taking it across the pits was interesting. The RTA inspector asked if the engine was standard to which I said that it was except for a number of performance parts that were available at the time the car was new. However the biggest problem was getting it across the actual pit as the car was low and fitted with rear tramp rods. I managed to get it on with what must have been just millimetres to spare, but got stuck getting it off. Anyway I had to go away and do something about it as well as fitting a second muffler. Next time it sailed through."

In Bob's Hands

"About two or three years later I got in contact with Bob Cutler." Steve said. "Since then Bob has been very generous with his time and advice on the car. Bob bought it in 1958, not with the intention of going racing, but to use as a sports car that was just a few years old. However like many a young man, then and now he had a hankering for a little extra performance. So he took it off the road to rebuild the engine and tweaked the suspension. Soon there was an entry at a hillclimb at Waterfall that so impressed Frank Matich. Bob later weighed his car and found that it was much lighter than the standard 100 due to its alloy panels."

"The list of modifications made to the car over time was extensive, but did include a range of performance parts from American supplier Iskanderian. By the fitting of Chev Corvette valves, larger bore flat top pistons and cylinder head work the compression ratio was raised to 11.5:1. Breathing was through headers and twin sand cast 2in SUs that Bob bought from Warnerfords at Woolloomooloo, a well known supplier of performance parts at the time. Interestingly the SUs came off Frank Gardner's Jaguar C-type when he went to triple Webers. For cooling Bob directed coolant from the cylinder head to the radiator through a four pipe exit manifold similar to Coventry Climax Grand Prix engines."

"Stopping would have been interesting." Steve added. "Bob quickly moved from the standard cast iron drums to DHMC supplied Alfin drums with transverse cooling vanes. The next step was front discs with Dunlop calipers and rotors especially made



A small selection of the trophies won by Bob Cutler and his 100. Bob Cutler Collection.



Bob Cutler and Ian 'Pete' Geoghegan. Steve Watson Collection.

for him by Lynx Engineering. It is a very quick car and would do the standing quarter mile in 14.8 seconds and easily wheelspin in every gear and was clocked at 140mph down Conrod Straight at Bathurst."

Warwick Farm

The 18th of December 1960 was an auspicious day for Sydney's motor racing fraternity as it was the opening race meeting at the new Warwick Farm circuit. The Australian Automobile Racing Club under the direction of Englishman, Geoff Sykes had set out a circuit in amongst the horse racing track.

What better cars to run in the very first race of that inaugural race meeting than production sports cars? What better car to be on pole position in that very first race than the Austin-Healey 100 of Bob Cutler? Other Austin-Healeys in that first race were the 100S of Sam Miller and the 100s Vince Profilo and Michael Bradley.

Unfortunately the weather gods didn't take too kindly to motor racing on that day and it just bucketed down. In fact it rained so much that looking across the circuit it was almost impossible to tell where the track finished and the infield started.

Behind the Cutler 100 on the grid was the Morgan of journalist David McKay and that's how the race lasted for quite some laps until at one corner the 100 aquaplaned off the circuit letting the Morgan through. The race finished with McKay out front, followed by Bob Cutler's Austin-Healey 100 and Harry Cape's MGA.

So the Cutler 100 was second in the very first race at the circuit that was to become Sydney's premier motor racing venue. Bob Cutler also won the NSW Sprint Championship in the 100 setting records in 1960 and '61



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as well as many other competition events. To this day the car and Bob are feigned for their achievements especially at Warwick Farm. As late as November last year the 100 took pride of place along with the McKay Morgan at the HSRCA's Tasman Revival race meeting at Eastern Creek.

Towards the end of Bob Cutler's ownership BMC started to pay attention and Bob found himself with financial support, as well as from Dunlop and BP. The 100 was even used in BMC UK based promotional material that sang the praises of this 3-litre Austin-Healey. No mention was made that it was a very much superseded model.

Drive It

"Since I bought the Cutler 100 I have just driven it." Steve answered to my question on how he uses the car. "It was our wedding car when Jan and I were married in 1985 and we went on our honeymoon in it. When we moved to Cooma it of course went with us and I would drive it everywhere with some enthusiasm – with the screen down of course no matter what the weather was like."

"It still runs the BN1 gearbox that Bob used in the car which has never caused any problems at all. I have talked at length to him about this as we all know they can be a weak point with the car, but he said that it is crucially important that all gear faces in the box line up one hundred percent."

"The car did let me down once," Steve added. "I was driving down through the Blue Mountains and the engine started running roughly. I had a look under the bonnet and saw that the fanbelt pulley seemed to be wobbling. It got me home, but I later discovered that the crankshaft had broken. I had Ken Waggott do the



Bob Cutler wrote to the DHMC in the hope to improve performance of his 100. Bob Cutler Collection.



The ex Bob Cutler Austin-Healey 100 & David McKay Morgan +4 at a HSRCA race meeting at Wakefield Park. Peter Schell Photo.



The Watson green 100.

machining for me, but when I took them the old crankshaft they just marvelled at how highly polished it was. I asked if he could polish the new crank the same, but he said that I really didn't have enough money for him to do that. In the end I polished it myself following Ken's detailed instructions."

"Now I am faced with a real quandary with the car. It still carries the paint that was put on it during the 1970s and it does need painting. Do I paint it or not? I honestly don't know because to

have a race car that looks as if it's straight off the showroom floor is a misrepresentation. Whatever I choose, I have made the decision not to race the car as I would never put it into a position where its history could be compromised in any way."

The Fourth 100

By now you are thinking what happened to Steve's fourth 100. Well it was 1974; the year after he bought the Cutler 100 that he was faced with a chance he couldn't pass up. It was an ex South Australian car that came up for sale in Double Bay and after some negotiation he along with old school mate Phillip Taylor paid \$375 for it. Again Steve thinks he probably paid too much for it, but it still runs as perfectly as the day he bought it. Steve and Phil even found the occasion to run the car in a couple of competition events such as a lap dash at Catalina Park at the beginning of 1975. "Later I paid out Phil's half and I became the sole owner"

All the Watson 100s are now in Sydney except for the green car that still enjoys its long rest in a barn in the Snowy Mountains.

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Little Works Austin-Healeys

It doesn't take all that long for the word to get around as us model collectors are a close knit bunch. No sooner than I received an email from a collector in Melbourne that the phone goes and it's Gordon Fryer in Queensland. Gordon used to be the secretary of the AHOC (NSW) some years back, but has since moved to Queensland. Over the years he has managed to collect quite a display of Austin-Healey memorabilia including an impressive display of models. Would he be Australia's Austin-Healey regalia king? Well if Gordon isn't, he is pretty close to it.

Anyway Gordon then proceeds to enthusiastically tell me about the new 1:18 scale Works Austin-Healeys from Japanese company Kyosho. Could Gordon resist the models at \$140.00 a piece? No, he was tickled pink at the opportunity of adding them to his burgeoning collection.

A quick check on the Kyosho website revealed that the company had recently released models of the ex Works cars UJB 143 and ARX 91B.

We know that while the Austin-Healey 3000 was introduced in 1959 it wasn't until the following year when the model made its international racing debut. This was in the form of four Mk1 BN7s prepared by the Donald Healey Motor Company for Sebring. Each car was painted British Racing Green and the registration numbers were UJB 140, UJB 141, UJB 142 and UJB 143.



The cars weren't entirely successful as two of the cars suffered gearbox problems with the vehicle driven by Jack Sears and Peter Riley finished third in class. The first car UJB 140 was the spare. Later on in that year UJB 143 was run at Le Mans, but retired with engine problems. The car was then sold to David Dixon and its registration changed to DD 300 and ran again at Le Mans in both 1961 and 1962 without success. Austin-Healey enthusiasts in the know would be well aware that it was this car that was later purchased by John Chatham and raced so successfully by him. Registration UJB 143 was subsequently fitted to a Works Rally 3000 which spent quite some years in Australia.

Rally Winner

Works Austin-Healey ARX 91B is a BJ8 built in 1963 and is perhaps one of the best known big Healeys built. Driven by Paddy Hopkirk with Henry Liddon beside him, the car went on to win the 1964 Austrian Rally outright. The following year it was driven





by Australian Paul Hawkins and Timo Makinen in the 1965 Targa Florio and is featured significantly in the film of the event – Mountain Legend.

I recall when our Club used to meet at the BMC theatrette at Zetland and courtesy of BMC the film was a popular attraction. If you have never seen this you have missed something rather special. Thankfully it is now available on YouTube.

Also in 1965 ARX 91B was driven by Paddy Hopkirk and Roger Mac in the 1,000 mile Guards Trophy event at Brands Hatch where they finished fourth overall.

Still Exists

It's good to know that despite the years both UJB 143 and ARX 91B still exist, with the former still racing as DD 300. What that means to the likes of us is that we would have next to no chance of having either parked in our garage.

If, however we were prepared to compromise a bit we could have the smaller versions of the cars in our study, office, garage or wherever we keep such things. The model of UJB 143 is a rendition of when it ran at Le Mans in 1960 while ARX 91B is as it was during the Austrian Rally.

Both Kyosho models are excellent renditions of our favourite cars. The Austin-Healey body shape has been beautifully captured by the model maker and the finish is perfect. Inside each cockpit is the real thing in miniature and it's a shame that I couldn't remove the hardtops for a closer look.

I did manage to look under the bonnet of the BJ8 and that is also excellent right down to triple 45DCOE Webbers. The bonnet of UJB 143 was held down by a leather strap which I wasn't prepared to undo. The under detail could be improved a little, but it



shouldn't turn anyone off.

I have been reviewing scale models for quite some years and one of the first things I look at are the wheels. You can tell a cheap model by its wheels, especially wire wheels. I am pleased to say that the wheels on those models are perfect for the cost of the model and a delight to look at.

About the only drawback of these Kyosho models is the shape of the hardtops. I just don't think the true shape has been captured especially in UJB 143. We all know that the hardtops for both roadster and convertible models are quite distinct and while that for the BJ8 is good, apart from too much chrome at the back, I think that of the BN7 looks to be cross between the both, plus there are no alloy support stays.

However both of these models will more than satisfy those amongst us who collect Austin-Healey models. They should be available wherever good models are sold, but if you are having trouble finding them give Mark at Model Cars Too a call on (02) 9290 2299.

Ceramic Coating

Since the Quinn Austin-Healey restoration was finished in 1985 I have had the need on a number of occasions to remove the exhaust and inlet manifolds. Leaking welsh plugs was one problem and to gain access to them you need to remove the exhaust and inlet manifolds as well as the carburettors.

I don't like the look of rusty exhaust manifolds so over the years I have painted them a number of times with so called heatproof paint. I said so called as the rust in time has come back. For the inlet manifold I originally just cleaned it, then had it abrasive blasted and some years later painted in engine colour.

So during the stripping down of the engine prior to its removal I thought it was time to do something more permanent. So I asked around with various members and Allan Whitehouse said that he had the exhaust manifolds on his BJ7 ceramic coated.

My first thought about this was having it not unlike early Jaguars manifolds that were vitreous enamelled, but no it's actually very different. So armed with a few websites I made contact with John Bates at J&J Performance located at South Penrith.

J&J Performance can undertake the complete range work for performance cars from simple servicing to custom fabrication, but they are also set up for sand blasting and ceramic coating.

I took the inlet and exhaust manifolds and asked for the exhaust to be finished in a dull black and the inlet stripped and with a clear coating applied.

Was I impressed with the result? Very much so and when I picked up the manifolds I asked John about the process.

The Process

"When you bought your exhaust manifolds in they were looking quite rusty." John said. "However whether it's new or old we go through the same process. First it's sand blasted with a coarse grey grit and then it's baked in the oven at 300° for one to two hours to removed any wax, grease or oil that may be still in the metal."

"After cooling down it goes into the fine sand blaster where it's blasted again so that it has a better textured finish providing a better look when the job is completely finished. What I did then to improve the finished look was to apply a base coat which raises what's called the 'tarnish point'. After being heated on the engine the coating will tend to dull slightly, but with a base coat it can be heated to 900° before that occurs."

"You wanted a dull black finish which we call 'Black Velvet' so what I did then is to take it back to the booth where the ceramic product was applied at about 0.2 to 0.5 mm thick coating. When I am happy with the coating it's then allow to cure for about five days, before it can go through a heat cycle on an engine."

"For the inlet manifold I took it through the coarse sand blaster first to remove all the paint. Then it was baked to remove any petrol or oils in the aluminium followed by fine sand blasting. Then I applied a micro clear coat to prevent any staining of the aluminium in the future, which again took five days to cure."



As removed from the engine.



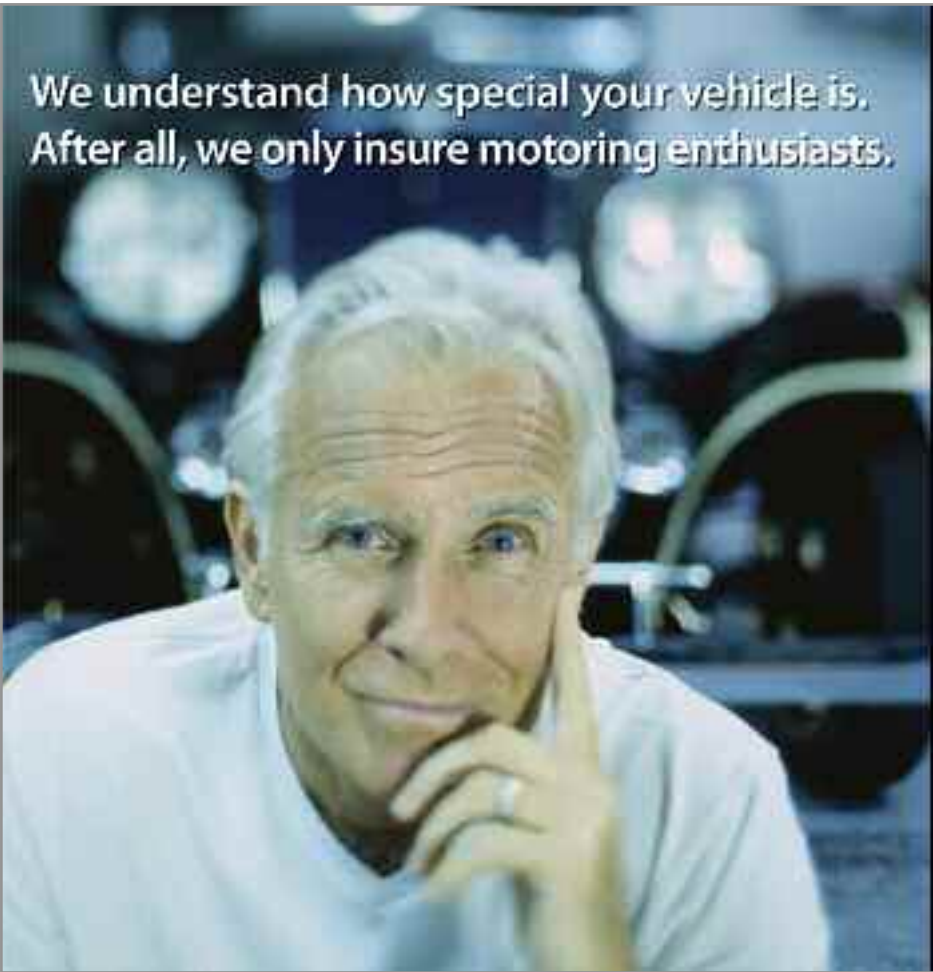
The manifold on the left has yet to be blasted.



Being baked to remove any oil.



Above left: After the first base coating has been applied. Abover right: The base coat complete.



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Bright Finish

I was interested in applications to other situations as clearly not everyone would want a dull black finish. In answer to my question John said that the process is very much the same.

"Yes for a shiny finish it's the coarse blast followed by baking and fine sand blast. That finish requires a two coat system so for anything that's to be shiny it's the base coat first of all. Then it's baked over time at various temperatures and then allowed to cool down. It's blasted again with the fine medium at very low pressure to just etch the surface of the base coat. Once that's done it's back into the booth to put on the ceramic which is called Chromex, our shiny finish product. Back into the oven again where it goes through a number of temperature ranges. It comes out with what looks to be a white finish and from there it goes into a polishing machine that brings out the chrome like effect. It's then wiped clean, washed down in acetone and is ready for the customer."



The ceramic coating still wet after application.

"The process is exactly the same for headers from a competition car whether it's cast iron, steel or even a set of rocker covers."

"Ceramic coating is more than just slapping on a product. On average it's anything from a 6 to 20 hour turn-around. It's all in the preparation, because if it's not prepared properly the product will fail. Generally that means that a customer has to leave their part

with us for at least a week, but that does depend on how busy we are. Plus for air cure applications I will not give it back to a customer until it's completely cured, or five days."

Besides the appearance, there is also the added benefit of an approximate reduction radiated heat of 25% as the coating is also applied to the inside of the manifolds. That's a huge benefit for under bonnet temperatures. The cost? John said that to ceramic coat the standard six-cylinder Austin-Healey exhaust is around \$170.00, but he is happy to provide a 15% discount to club members who bring along this issue of Flat Chat.

J&J Performance is at Unit 5, 10a Production Place, Penrith 2750. You can call on (02) 4722 3916 or have a look at www.jj-performance.com.au/index



Finished and back home.

Lance's 100



Like many of us we are repeatedly approached by people who used to own Austin-Healeys, or their brother did, or their cousin, their neighbour, or perhaps their ex significant half etc had one over the years. It's a real 'six degrees of separation' situation, but for us it involves Austin-Healeys.

At Wings Over Illawarra a few months back I was introduced to a gentleman by the name of Lance Harkus and yes he used to own an Austin-Healey during the late 1950s and early 1960s. He was kind enough to send me some photos and scans of newspaper clippings from the period. It is interesting that Lance was a contemporary of Bob Cutler and also enjoyed some motor sport during his period of ownership.

Lance would like to track down his 100 to see if it still exists, but unfortunately he only has the registration number – BKZ-537. He thought that he did have the original hire purchase documents, but sadly these have been misplaced.

Lance Harkus purchased the car in Sept/Oct 1957 which was painted white with an iridescent maroon flash. Once he caught the competition bug he undertook quite a few modifications to the car including oversize valves, porting/polishing, 45 degree overlap camshaft, 9 to 1 compression ratio, 17 pounds machined out of the flywheel, imported Derrington extractor exhaust system and twin exhaust pipes through a dual throat muffler. To improve engine cooling Lance installed a gallery of additional water copper tubes that ran down the side of the cylinder head and connecting the four head hot spots and the radiator header tank. This was a common modification of the

At Lady Macquarie's Chair, Sydney (right). Unfortunately you can no longer drive on the grass.

In the pits(left) at Silverdale Hillclimb. The Cutler car in the background.

period that had the additional benefit of eliminating running-on that is prevalent with an increased compression ratio.

In an email Lance says that it was a very quick car and could easily run to 120mph on the clock with a bit of a straight road. However he also says that the bronze bushes in the gearbox didn't last long between rebuilds and was the primary reason why he sold it. Not surprisingly Lance said that was a sad day as the 100 was a lovely looking car and a delight to drive on a dry road, but could be a handful in the wet.

The photos Lance kindly sent includes one taken at Silverdale hillclimb and behind his

car is Bob Cutler's 100 with Bob undertaking a little fettling. The printed sheets from a hillclimb at Bumble Hill, Yarramalong just inland from the Central Coast are also interesting. Not just because it shows Lance as achieving fastest time of the day in his 100, but also mentioning Bruce McPhee and Barry Mulholland



Lance Harkus' 100 taken at the Central Coast.



Damaged car repaired to set hill climb record

A contestant whose car was damaged in an early practice run worked all day to repair it and establish a course and class record in the concluding stage of events at the Central Coast Car Club hill climb at Bumble Hill, Yarramalong, on Sunday.

He is Lance Harkus of North Gosford, who drove an Austin-Healey sports car.

He clipped 2.6 seconds off the previous course record of 56.6 seconds up the steep five-eighths mile winding course.

Harkus' record of 54 seconds was established in the last run of the day up the course.

In his first morning practice run Harkus' sports car had slid off the road up a rocky bank, bending the front suspension.

He then worked all day to repair his vehicle.

IRONY

An ironical twist to the win was that Harkus was lent a spare wheel by Max Nethery, Gosford, (Austin - Healey), whose then record of 54.8 seconds he went on to better.

The cars were winners of the sports car over 1500 cc section.

Over 30 contestants and 250 spectators went to Yarramalong for the hill climb.

Car club officials said this week the event was among the most successful the club had conducted with good weather conditions and the use of an electronic timing device and public address system.

RESULTS

Other winners were: Sports car under 1500 cc: M. Farrey, Terrigal, MG Special 53.2 seconds 1, N. Finlay, Ourimbah, 69.6s 2.

Sedan cars, 751-1000cc: D. Handford, Niagara Park, Standard 10, 68.7s.

1001-1300cc: N. Simpson, The Entrance, Simca, 57.8s 1, W. Sherring, Gosford, Volkswagen, 66.8s 2, S. Butler, Green Point, Austin A40 80s 3.

1301-1600cc: B. Morris, Terrigal, Hillman, 61.6s 1, J. Clancy, Morris Major, 68.5s 2.

1601-2000cc: W. Thompson, Narara, Austin Lancer, 57.4s 1.

2001-2500cc: J. Hicks, Belmont, Holden, 55.3s 1, B. McPhee, Wyong, Holden, 57.4s 2, B. Mulholland, Mt. White, 59s 3, B. Mohr, Kanwal, Holden 60.2s 4, D. Levenspiel, Wyong, Holden, 61.4s eq. 5, J. Clancy, Hudson Jet, 61.4s eq. 5, B. Levy, The Entrance, Holden, 62.4 eq. 7, B. James, Kilmara, Zephyr, 62.4 eq. 7, J. Purton, Holden, 65.4s 9.

Over 2500cc: Driver's name not recorded, Jaguar, 68.5s.

DEFERRED

The car club's 50 mile "scramble trial" which was to have been held this Sunday will not take place because official permission was unable to be obtained in time.

The trial will now be held later, probably next month.

The annual Libraries Conference opened in Sydney on Tuesday by the Governor, Sir Eric Woodward, has been attended this week by the club's librarian, Mrs. M. Whelan of Gosford and Mrs. E. Graham of Point Clare.



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who would team together to win the 1968 Bathurst Hardie-Ferodo 500 in a Holden Monaro GTS 327. By the way Bumble Hill still exists, but it's now used for bicycle races and not cars.

Sadly with just the knowledge of the registration number of Lance's car it will be difficult to track down, but perhaps it rings a bell with you. If so let me know and the necessary introductions will be arranged.



This month we are indebted to Neville Stirton for letting me know about a trio of Healey oddities for sale on the other side of the world.

However before moving on to them let's look at a 100M that was recently sold on eBay as well as a very low mileage 100. It appears that the 100M was bought as a job lot of a number of 100s. The story went that the car had been raced during the 1950s and that led the owner to check further. Eventually he obtained a Heritage Certificate that revealed that the car was indeed one of 640 100Ms built.

The car then passed through a few hands until it finally ended up with someone with enough cash or sense to restore it properly. It was then used for further

competition and following that received further TLC.

The car was placed on eBay for US\$10,000, but it eventually sold for US\$100,000 or around \$93,200 in our coins of the realm.

Now here is a story that beats all low mileage stories. A white BN2 was bought by a Chicago couple in 1956 and just a short time later the he half dies. The widow, understandably distraught, keeps the car and stores it in her living room, out of the weather. It's serviced annually and over time has 500 miles on the odometer. The car is sold and becomes part of a collection. However it's sold again and the next owner adds a red flash, rebuilds it mechanically and from the photos it looks freshly restored.

It now has just 747 miles on the clock



from new and is up for sale by Canepa Design in California for an undisclosed sum. Incredible? Surely, but if I found a car with just 747 miles it would have to be very far gone before I would restore it.

As mentioned, Neville has alerting us that Hyman Ltd Classic Cars in St Louis has three unusual Healeys for sale. These are a 1953 Healey Abbott, a 1953 Nash Healey roadster and a 1954 Nash Healey Coupe.

The Abbott has been finished in cream with red trim, is listed for US\$53,500 and looks to be a lovely car. The Nash Healey Roadster has just 72,000 miles on the clock and while in going condition does need restoring. It can be yours for US\$57,500.

The Nash Healey Coupe certainly needs a restoration and has its Nash six-cylinder engine removed, but comes with the car. A stylish motor car that would be a real stunner fitted with a Nash 250ci V8 from the same period. For just US\$36,500 you would have the only Nash Healey Coupe in Australia.

For something completely different and certainly not for the fainthearted there was a Healey Marine Sports Boat on eBay a few weeks back. It looked in terrible condition, but the ad stated that some of the frame is sound. Plus it came with 2 engines and a Healey gearbox. Priced at £370 it didn't sell.





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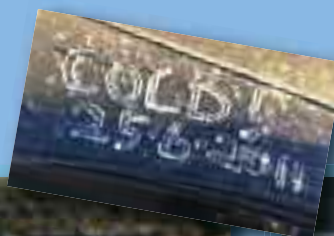


The Healey Factory is proud to offer you the DMD Australia range of high quality components for Austin Healey engines. The range has been developed to extract performance improvements while maintaining maximum reliability for both competition and road use.

DMD products have been subjected to extensive dyno and competition testing prior to release.

Back Page Pics

AHOC Supersprint - 25th June 2011



Wakefield Park cold? It's hard to imagine. Greg Denning Photo.



The Sell 3000 accelerating away. John Smith Photo.



Greg Denning and his BJ8 at Wakefield Park. John Smith Photo.



Cameron Sell hard cornering his 3000 at Wakefield Park. John Smith Photo.



John Dowsett and Sue Denning basking in the winter sunshine while marking off the runners. Greg Denning Photo.



While at dinner Doug Ross says "Stop looking at my menu!" while Christine Lyttle and Jim Phillips wonder what's going on. Greg Denning Photo.



John Kent attempting to swing the Austin-Healey choir action during the Wakefield Park Eisteddfod. Greg Denning Photo.



"The winner gets to pick which door they want." John Kent says to Margaret Smith while Kay Britten and Chris Dimmock look on. Greg Denning Photo.



Below L to R. Margaret Smith, Jo Hutton, Carolyn Kent, Charlie Britten, Kay Britten, John Kent, Allan Whitehouse and Geoff Smith. Greg Denning Photo.



Scrutineering girls - L to R: Carolyn Kent, Jo Hutton, Sue Denning, Margaret Smith, Jill Dowsett and Muriel Roberts. Allan Whitehouse Photo.



Racing Healeys - L to R: Mike Branson, Chris Komor, Scott Graham, Greg Denning. Allan Whitehouse Photo.